

Writing

Sentences

A sentence is a group of words that make sense together. A sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with a period. All sentences contain a verb.

Some sentences are quite short.

This is an elephant.
Elephants love water.

We can make sentences longer by joining on more clauses using **conjunctions**.

*Elephants love water **and** they can swim quite well.*

I packed the following:



Punctuation

- You put a period at the end of a sentence.
The cat sat on the mat.
- ? You put a question mark at the end of a question.
Where do you live?
- ! You put an exclamation mark at the end of a command or an exclamation.
Come here!
What beautiful flowers!
- , You put a comma to separate parts of a sentence, or divide up a list of things.
He's only five, but he can swim really well.
I bought apples, oranges, and pears.
- ' An apostrophe is used to shorten two words into one, or to show who something belongs to.
I don't know.
That's my dad's pen.
- : You can use a colon in front of a list.
I packed the following: three T-shirts, two pairs of shorts, sandals, and sunscreen.
- ; You can use a semicolon as a pause in a sentence, or to separate two different subjects in one sentence.
There wasn't much to do; it was raining again!
- A hyphen joins two words together.
I'm right-handed.
- A dash can be used when you want to add more information.
I was so happy – we had won!
- () You put something in parenthesis if it is an extra idea and not part of the main text.
Crocodiles (which are reptiles) need the sun to keep warm.
- “” or “” You put quotation marks, or inverted commas, around the words that someone says.
“Hello,” he said. “Who are you?”